

1 Sentence Fragment

◆ Definition

A **sentence fragment** is an **incomplete sentence**.

It does **not express a complete thought** because it is missing **one or more** of these:

- a **subject**
- a **verb**
- or a **complete idea**

☞ Fragments **cannot stand alone** as sentences.

◆ Common Types of Fragments

1. Fragment without a verb

- ✗ *She very intelligent.*
✓ *She **is** very intelligent.*
-

2. Fragment without a subject

- ✗ *Went to the market.*
✓ *He went to the market.*
-

3. Fragment starting with a subordinating word

(words like **because, although, when, if**)

- ✗ *Because I was late.*
✓ *I missed the class because I was late.*
-

4. Fragment as a phrase

- ✗ *After the final exam.*
✓ *We went home after the final exam.*

◆ Exam Tip

If a sentence **cannot answer “who did what?”**, it is probably a **fragment**.

2 Run-On Sentence

◆ Definition

A **run-on sentence** occurs when **two or more independent (complete) sentences are joined incorrectly without proper punctuation or conjunction**.

☞ The ideas are complete, but **not properly separated**.

◆ Types of Run-On Sentences

1. Fused Sentence (no punctuation at all)

✗ *I like English it is my favorite subject.*

✓ *I like English. It is my favorite subject.*

2. Comma Splice (only comma used)

✗ *I was tired, I slept early.*

✓ *I was tired, so I slept early.*

✓ *I was tired. I slept early.*

◆ Correct Ways to Fix a Run-On

You can correct run-ons by:

1. Using a **full stop**
2. Using a **comma + conjunction** (and, but, so, because)
3. Using a **semicolon**

◆ More Examples

✗ *She is intelligent she works hard.*

✓ *She is intelligent, and she works hard.*

✗ *He studied a lot he passed the exam.*

✓ *He studied a lot; he passed the exam.*

↻ Fragment vs Run-On (Quick Difference)

Fragment

Incomplete sentence

Missing subject/verb

Not a full idea

Run-On

Too many sentences joined

Missing punctuation

Too many full ideas

📌 Exam-Style Practice

Identify the error:

1. *Although he was sick.*

☞ **Fragment**

2. *I like coffee I drink it daily.*

☞ **Run-on sentence**